6 Charts on SpaceX's Pre-IPO Financials

A look at how SpaceX makes money, how it loses money, and what the IPO cashout will look like for key investors and execs.

Rosie Bradbury • May 22, 2026

Share

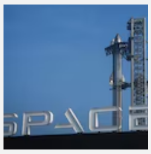
AaronP/Bauer-Griffin/GC via Getty

SpaceX published its landmark S-1 filing on Wednesday, offering the most comprehensive picture of its financials to date. In its top-line figures, the Starlink creator disclosed that it brought in $18 billion in revenue in 2025 on a consolidated basis, with a net loss of $4.9 billion. EBITDA came in at $6.58 billion for the year.

That exponential growth trajectory has been nearly two decades in the making. SpaceX was founded in 2002 by Elon Musk, and it has raised more than $10 billion in venture capital funding over its lifetime as a private company. Now, a slew of investors—including Founder's Fund, DFJ, D1 Capital, Fidelity, and Thrive Capital—and thousands of early employees are gearing up for a generational liquidity event.

SpaceX’s IPO Filing: Big Spending, Big Losses

The first public financials from Elon Musk’s company highlight Starlink’s revenue power and increased spending on AI.



‘Financials Look Reckless’: Lifting xAI’s Hood in the SpaceX IPO

The Grok maker’s losses are accelerating, as SpaceX’s IPO pulls back the curtain on a large AI model company’s financials for the first time.

From 2024 to 2025, SpaceX’s revenue grew 33%. In the first three months of 2026, its revenue rose 15% year-over-year. But digging a little deeper, the picture gets much more complex. Though SpaceX was originally pitched as a space exploration company, its most profitable segment is Starlink, a satellite constellation offering high-speed internet. Starlink recorded an 86% increase in adjusted EBITDA between 2024 and 2025, while its total subscribers doubled.

Starlink dominates SpaceX's earnings

SpaceX's S-1 revealed that its Starlink business brought in much of the company's cash.

$8B

$6B

Source: Securities filing • As of May 20, 2026

Still, SpaceX is operating at a net loss, reflecting the capital intensity of its business even compared with manufacturers like Rivian and Tesla.

Rockets aren't cheap

It's no secret that SpaceX is a capital-intensive business. The aerospace company reported a net loss of $4.93 billion on $18.67 billion of revenue in 2025, a much larger negative margin than Palantir or CoreWeave

Total revenue Net income/loss

Source: PitchBook, 10-K filings
Note: All figures refer to the fiscal year 2025 ending December 31, 2025 except for Snowflake, whose 2025 fiscal year ended Jan. 31, 2026

SpaceX has further increased its spending following its acquisition of xAI in February 2026. Starlink's success is effectively subsidizing xAI's extensive expenditures. The AI segment recorded a $6.35 billion operating loss in 2025, taking SpaceX into the red.

SpaceX's xAI premium

SpaceX's merger with Grok creator xAI brought the aerospace company into a loss-making position in 2025.

$4B

$2B

$0B

Source: Securities filings • As of May 20, 2026

The exit value generated by SpaceX's IPO is unprecedented. At an expected $1.675 trillion pre-money valuation, the IPO would generate more exit value than all VC-backed IPOs in the last decade combined.

It could also open the door for a flurry of other public listings that VCs have been eagerly anticipating. On deck this year are AI giants OpenAI and Anthropic. For LPs invested in funds holding SpaceX shares, the IPO will likely be the largest liquidity distribution event in years—a potential boon for the asset class.

Blowing IPOs out of the water

The SpaceX IPO alone could generate more exit value than all IPOs in the last decade.

$2,000B

$1,500B

Exit value SpaceX Exit count

Source: PitchBook • Geography: US • As of May 20, 2026

This massive IPO will create huge wealth for SpaceX's largest shareholders, especially Musk. Such a position isn't unusual for a sole founder, but the scale of the payout is. Musk is expected to become the world's first trillionaire in the coming years, thanks to SpaceX's growth.

The VCs that invested early in SpaceX are likely to see an enormous payoff as well—DFJ, Founders Fund, Craft Ventures, and Adapt Ventures all invested in SpaceX before its valuation even hit $1 billion.

Cashing in

Elon Musk is the only person or entity with a more than 5% stake in SpaceX.

Stockholder	SpaceX position	Class A shares	Class A shares (%)	Class B shares	Class B shares (%)
Elon Musk	Founder, CEO of SpaceX	849,494,440	12.3%	5,569,053,075	93.6%
Antonio J. Gracias	Founder, Valor Equity Partners. Co-led SpaceX's Series F at a $1B valuation.	503,414,530	7.3%		*
Gwynne Shotwell	President of SpaceX	5,460,400	*	7,113,550	*
Luke Nosek	Made the first institutional check from Founders Fund at a $420M valuation. Now leads Gigafund, which has invested over $1B in SpaceX since 2017.	32,987,360	*		*
Bret Johnsen	CFO of SpaceX	9,583,690	*		*
	Founder, Managing Partner of DBL Partners. DBL Partners co-led				

Source: Securities filing • As of May 20, 2026
Note: An asterisk (*) represents beneficial ownership of less than 1%.

The next test for the company and its investors is whether its ambitious valuation holds up in the public markets long enough for VC lock-ups to expire.

The tortoise vs. the hare

SpaceX took its time getting to an IPO, meaning that much of its valuation growth occured before its listing.

Company SpaceX Tesla Meta Uber Palantir Arm

Note: SpaceX's market cap of $1.75T is an estimated figure, and could change.
As of May 20, 2025

Editor's Note: This article was originally published on PitchBook.com.

The author or authors do not own shares in any securities mentioned in this article. Find out about Morningstar's editorial policies.

Share

Popular

View All

The 5 Best Dividend Aristocrats to Buy in 2026

How to avoid the dividend aristocrat trap.

Susan Dziubinski • Jun 3, 2026

5 Stocks to Sell in June

Plus, a look at last month's stock market winners and losers.

David Sekera, CFA and Susan Dziubinski • Jun 1, 2026

3 New Vanguard Active ETFs That Stand Out

A look at the firm's smart choices concerning these equity funds.

Daniel Sotiroff and Ivanna Hampton • Jun 4, 2026

The Portfolio That Has Been Beating the Classic 60/40, and Why It Matters for You

Plus, one of the biggest challenges to portfolio diversification today.

Amy C. Arnott, CFA and Ivanna Hampton • Jun 5, 2026

This AI Winner Has Been Unstoppable. Is It Time to Sell?

Astonishing results have driven this AI stock into significantly overvalued territory.

William Kerwin, CFA • Jun 4, 2026

About the Author

View All Authors >

Rosie Bradbury

Senior Reporter, Venture Capital

More from Author >

Rosie Bradbury is a senior reporter for PitchBook.

6 Charts on SpaceX's Pre-IPO Financials

Rosie Bradbury • May 22, 2026

'Financials Look Reckless': Lifting xAI's Hood in the SpaceX IPO

Rosie Bradbury • May 21, 2026

Fervo Rides Data Center Energy Boom With 35% IPO Pop

Rosie Bradbury • May 14, 2026

MORNINGSTAR

United States